

Branding Handbook

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ABSTRACT

A guide to the visual identity and design language of felixweber.co.uk, including typography, colour palette, gradients, text shadows, borders, buttons, spacing, and design principles.

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CHAPTER 1

Branding Handbook

Branding Handbook

This handbook documents the visual identity and design language for felixweber.co.uk.

Typography

Typefaces

Role	Typeface	Format
Display/Headings/Buttons	PixChicago	TTF, WOFF
Body/UI Text	w95fa	WOFF2
Fallback	sans-serif	System

PixChicago is a pixel-style bitmap font evoking classic Mac OS Chicago. It is used exclusively for all headings (H1–H6), buttons, and any interactive UI labels to reinforce the retro identity.

w95fa is a Windows 95-inspired proportional font used for all body text and prose. Its familiar, slightly chunky letterforms complement PixChicago without competing with it.

Type Scale

Element	Size	Notes
Hero H1 (header)	2.5em	Gradient + text-shadow, PixChicago
H1 (content)	2em	Pink shadow offset
H2	1.5em	Cyan shadow offset
H3	1em	No shadow
H2 (header subtitle)	1.2em	Centred
Body	16px base	w95fa, line-spacing 1.2
Buttons/.btn	0.8em	PixChicago, no underline

Text Styling Rules

- > Line height for headings and buttons: 1.2
- > Line spacing for body: 1.2
- > Links: Underline appears on hover only
- > Buttons: text-decoration: none always; underline suppressed
- > Text alignment: All headings within header are centred

Colour Palette

The palette blends a soft lavender background with neutral content surfaces and two signature wide-gamut neon accent colours. Where supported, Display P3 colour values are used over sRGB fallbacks for more vivid reproduction.

Base Colours

Name	Hex/Value	Usage
Page Background	#faf0fa	<body> background – soft lavender white
Page Background (alt)	#f0fafafa	<body> background – soft baby blue white
Surface/Card	#f6f6f6	Sections, header, main – light neutral
Foreground/Text	#333333	Primary body text, HR borders
Mobile Background	#f6f6f6	Body background on screens ≤ 600px

Button Colours

State	Colour
Default	#d3d3d3 (light grey)
Hover	#c0c0c0 (silver)
Active/Pressed	#a9a9a9 (dark grey)
Readability Button (default)	rgba(228, 173, 255, 1) – soft lavender
Readability Button (pressed)	rgba(181, 105, 212, 1) – medium purple

Accent Colours (Neon)

Name	sRGB Fallback	Display P3	Usage
Neon Magenta	<code>rgba(251, 8, 255, 0.64)</code>	<code>color(display-p3 1 0.0039 1)</code>	H1 text-shadow, gradient start
Neon Cyan	<code>rgba(8, 218, 255, 0.64)</code>	<code>color(display-p3 0.0039 0.8549 1)</code>	H2 text-shadow, gradient end

Declare the sRGB `rgba()` value first, then the `color(display-p3 ...)` override. Browsers that support Display P3 will use the richer value; others fall back gracefully.

Gradients

Hero Title Gradient

Used on the `<header>` `<h1>` element as a clipping gradient to colour the text.

```
Direction:      45deg
Start colour:   color(display-p3 1 0.0039 1)      [Neon Magenta]
End colour:    color(display-p3 0.0039 0.8549 1)  [Neon Cyan]
Background-size: 40% 100%
Background-position: center
Animation:      gradient - 10s ease infinite
```

The gradient is applied using `background-clip: text` and `-webkit-text-fill-colour: transparent`. This makes the gradient text appear like the shadow of the bold black text to the user. However, technically, the dark drop-shadow created with `4px 4px 0 colour(display-p3 0 0 0.2)` is actually the shadow of the gradient text even though it looks like the main bold black text.

sRGB:


```
background: linear-gradient(  
  45deg,  
  rgba(251, 8, 255, 0.64),  
  rgba(8, 218, 255, 0.64)  
);
```

Display P3:

```
background: linear-gradient(  
  45deg,  
  color(display-p3 1 0.0039 1),  
  color(display-p3 0.0039 0.8549 1)  
);
```

Text Shadows

H1 (Content Sections)

An offset pink pixel shadow evokes retro chromatic aberration.

```
text-shadow: -1px 1px 0 rgba(251, 8, 255, 0.64);  
text-shadow: -1px 1px 0 color(display-p3 1 0.0039 1);
```

H2 (Content Sections)

A matching cyan offset shadow.

```
text-shadow: -1px 1px 0 rgba(8, 218, 255, 0.64);  
text-shadow: -1px 1px 0 color(display-p3 0.0039 0.8549 1);
```

Hero H1 Drop Shadow

```
text-shadow: 4px 4px 0 rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.3);  
text-shadow: 4px 4px 0 color(display-p3 0 0 0.2);
```

Borders & Surfaces

Pixel-Corner Border

Cards (header, main, section) use an SVG pixel-corner border image to simulate a chunky retro frame.

```
border: 15px solid transparent;  
border-image: url("pixel-corner.svg") 20 round;  
border-radius: 20px;
```

- > Border width: 15px
- > Border-image slice: 20
- > Border-image repeat: round
- > Border-radius: 20px (rounded corners under the border image)
- > Mobile override ($\leq 600\text{px}$): Border removed entirely; `border: 0; border-image: none; border-radius: 0`

Divider

```
<hr>
```

```
border: none;  
border-top: 4px dotted #333;  
margin: 20px 0;
```

A 4px dotted line in foreground colour. Within lists, the final `<hr>` is hidden (`display: none`).

Post Header Title

```
border-bottom: 4px dotted #333;
```

Matching dotted underline applied below `.post-header > h1`.

Buttons

Base Button

```
.btn
```

```
background-color: #d3d3d3;
color: #000;
padding: 10px 15px;
border: 2px solid #000;
border-radius: 5px;
font-family: "PixChicago", sans-serif;
font-size: 0.8em;
box-shadow:
  inset 0 2px 0 rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.5),
  inset 0 -2px 0 rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.5);
transition:
  background-color 120ms ease,
  transform 120ms ease,
  box-shadow 120ms ease;
```

The double inset shadow creates a bevelled/raised appearance consistent with the Windows 95 aesthetic.

Button States

State	Background	Box-Shadow	Transform
Default	#d3d3d3	inset 0 2px 0 rgba(255,255,255,0.5), inset 0 -2px 0 rgba(0,0,0,0.5)	–
Hover	#c0c0c0	Same as default	–
Active/Pressed	#a9a9a9	inset 0 -3px 0 rgba(9,8,8,0.6)	translateY(2px)

Pressed state uses `aria-pressed="true"` for accessibility. The `translateY(2px)` shift and reversed shadow simulate a physical button depression.

Readability Button

```
#readability-btn
```

A special accent button using the lavender–purple palette.

State	Background
Default	rgba(228, 173, 255, 1)
Pressed	rgba(181, 105, 212, 1)

The readability button toggles pixel-style body fonts on and off; when depressed, the body text changes to a sans-serif font.

Spacing & Layout

Page Layout

Property	Value
Body padding	20px
Body margin	20px
Max content width	900px
Content horizontal alignment	margin: 0 auto (centred)

Property	Value
Card margin-bottom	20px

Card Inner Spacing

- > Border of 15px (creates visual inset padding via border-image)
- > No explicit inner padding defined on cards; content relies on child element padding

Row/Flex Layout

```
display: flex;
flex-wrap: wrap;
justify-content: space-evenly;
align-items: center;
padding: 10px;
gap: 10px;
```

Used for arranging multiple items (links, buttons, images) horizontally with even distribution and wrapping on smaller screens.

Heading Spacing

```
margin: 10px;
padding-bottom: 15px;
text-align: center; /* header context */
```

Mobile Breakpoint

≤ 600px

Property	Change
Body background	#f6f6f6 (matches card surface)
Body padding	10px
Body margin	10px
Card border	Removed
Card border-radius	0

Images

```
img {  
  max-width: 100%;  
  height: auto;  
}
```

All images are fully responsive, scaling down within their container without distortion.

Design Principles

1. Wide-gamut where possible, and always provide an sRGB fallback before the `color(display-p3 ...)` declaration. The neon accents exist beyond the sRGB gamut – on P3 displays they appear noticeably more vivid.
2. Interactive elements (e.g. buttons) use a greyscale palette (silver → grey progression) so that neon text colours and the readability button's lavender always read as accent elements.
3. Buttons must use `aria-pressed` to communicate toggle state both visually (transform + shadow inversion) and semantically. Accessibility is a first-class requirement.

CHAPTER 2

Files

LaTeX

A `felixweber.latex` file defines the pandoc-LaTeX template for PDF generation in line with the `felixweber.co.uk` identity.